



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Product/Services Management

BUSINESS SERVICES MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of product mix.
2. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.
3. Develop positioning concepts for a new product idea.
4. Identify company's unique selling proposition.
5. Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Director of Client Strategy for VIRTUAL PATHWAYS, a business-to-business (B2B) firm that provides customized online training and professional development services to medium-sized corporations. The Vice President of Sales (judge) wants you to analyze a proposed new service offering designed to capture a higher-value market segment.

VIRTUAL PATHWAYS has been operating successfully for ten years, specializing in compliance training (HR/safety) and basic software onboarding modules. The company's core brand promise is high reliability, deep customization for client needs, and dedicated support. VIRTUAL PATHWAYS currently services over 300 corporate clients, charging based on the number of modules utilized per employee.

Recently, market data suggests a high demand among corporate executives for remote, flexible soft-skills development, particularly in leadership, advanced communication, and team dynamics. This market often uses expensive, highly exclusive third-party consultants or physical retreats. The Vice President (judge) believes VIRTUAL PATHWAYS can leverage its technology and customization expertise to offer a premium suite of Executive Leadership Modules through its existing digital platform.

The Vice President (judge) is eager to launch this new service to increase recurring revenue and enhance the corporate brand, but is concerned about positioning the "luxury" training alongside the existing, more fundamental compliance services.

The Vice President (judge) wants you to analyze the new service and determine:

- The unique selling proposition of the new Executive Leadership Modules.
- How adding this premium service will affect the overall VIRTUAL PATHWAYS product mix.
- Specific factors used to position the Executive Leadership Modules to attract high-value clientele.
- Key factors in building this new segment of clientele, focusing on customer service delivery.

You will present your analysis to the Vice President of Sales (judge) in a meeting to take place in the Vice President's (judge's) office. The Vice President (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your analysis and have answered the Vice President's (judge's) questions, the Vice President (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. The existing client base is accustomed to buying compliance and HR/safety training. How would you get your clientele to purchase Executive Leadership Modules?

2. If the new Executive Leadership Modules are considered a "premium" product for high-value clients, how should the company's approach to pricing or charging potentially change to reflect this new status?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of product mix?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Develop positioning concepts for a new product idea?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Identify company's unique selling proposition.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify product's/service's competitive advantage?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						